“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 17

The Journey to Śrī Vṛndāvana

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 As Gaura went to Vṛndāvana, He made the tigers, elephants, deer and birds of the forest mad with love: they danced along with Him and chanted the name of Kṛṣṇa.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Gauracandra! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![2]

3 When autumn came, the Lord resolved to set out, and He took counsel in private with Rāmānanda and Svarūpa.

4 “If you two will help Me, then I can go and see Śrī Vṛndāvana.

5 I shall rise at night and slip away by the forest path. I shall go alone and take no one with Me.

6 If anyone gets up and runs after Me to keep Me company, hold them all back, so that no one follows.

7 Give Me leave gladly, and do not take it as a sorrow. If you are all happy, I shall be happy on the road.”

8 The two of them said, “You are the independent Lord. Whatever You wish, You will do; You depend on no one.

9 But hear one request from the two of us. You Yourself have said, ‘In your happiness is My happiness.’

10 Our hearts will be very happy, O merciful Lord, if You grant us one request.

11 We must ask that one good brāhmaṇa go with You. He will collect alms and give You Your meals, and he will carry Your waterpot.

12 On the forest path there is no brāhmaṇa whose food You could accept. Permit one brāhmaṇa to go with You.”

13 The Lord said, “I shall not take any of My own companions. If I take one, the others will be unhappy.

14 Let My companion be someone new, whose heart is full of love. If I find such a person, I will take that one alone.”[3]

15 Svarūpa said, “Here is Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya. He is full of love for You, and he is learned, saintly and noble.

16 He came with You from Gauḍa at the very start, and he wishes to visit all the holy places.[4]

17 With him is a brāhmaṇa servant, and on the road the Bhaṭṭācārya himself will serve You and see to Your meals.

18 If You take him with You, everyone will be happy, and You will meet no hardship on the forest path.

19 That brāhmaṇa will carry Your cloth and waterpot, and the Bhaṭṭācārya will go begging alms and give You Your meals."

20 The Lord accepted Svarūpa's words and took Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya with Him.

21 The night before, He saw Jagannātha and received His permission. Then, rising at the end of the night, the Lord set out in secret.

22 In the morning the devotees could not find the Lord, and they went about searching for Him in distress.

23 Svarūpa Gosāñi held them all back, and knowing the Lord's mind, they all gave up the search.

24 Leaving the main road, the Lord went by a side path. Keeping Kaṭaka on His right, He entered the forest.

25 The Lord went through the lonely forest chanting Kṛṣṇa's name, and elephants and tigers left the path when they saw Him.

26 There were herds of tigers, elephants, rhinoceroses and boars, and the Lord, absorbed in ecstasy, made His way through their midst.

27 Seeing this, the Bhaṭṭācārya was terrified, but by the Lord's power the animals stood aside.

28 One day a tiger was lying on the path, and the Lord, lost in ecstasy, touched its body with His foot.

29 The Lord said, "Say 'Kṛṣṇa'!" The tiger rose and began to dance, saying, "Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!"

30 On another day, while Mahāprabhu was bathing in a river, a herd of maddened elephants came to drink.

31 As the Lord performed His rites in the water, the elephants came before Him. Crying, “Say ‘Kṛṣṇa’!”, the Lord splashed water at them.[5]

32 Every elephant those drops of water touched cried, “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!” and danced and sang in love.

33 Some fell to the ground, and some trumpeted loudly. Seeing this, the Bhaṭṭācārya was struck with wonder.

34 As He went along the road, the Lord would sing the holy name aloud, and hearing His sweet voice, the does came to Him.

35 Listening to the sound, they walked with the Lord on His right and left. The Lord stroked them and joyfully recited a verse:

36 “How blessed are these does! Foolish though they are, on hearing the flute, they and their mates, the black bucks, have worshipped the wondrously attired son of Nanda with their loving glances.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.21.11)[6]

37 Just then five or seven tigers came there, and the tigers and does walked together with Mahāprabhu.

38 Seeing this, Mahāprabhu remembered Vṛndāvana, and He recited a verse describing its glories:

39 “There, in the abode of the Unconquerable Lord, men and beasts, enemies by nature, lived together like friends, and anger, thirst and the like had fled away.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.13.60)[7]

40 When the Lord said, “Say ‘Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!’” the tigers and deer began to dance, saying, “Kṛṣṇa!”

41 The tigers danced and wept together with the does, and Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya watched, amazed at this wondrous play.

42 The tigers and deer embraced one another, and putting mouth to mouth, they kissed.

43 Seeing this delightful scene, the Lord began to laugh. Then He left them all there and went on ahead.

44 At the sight of the Lord, peacocks and other birds went along with Him, crying “Kṛṣṇa” and dancing as if mad.

45 The Lord called aloud, “Hari bol!” and the trees and creepers rejoiced to hear it.

46 Giving Kṛṣṇa’s name to all the moving and nonmoving beings of Jhārikhaṇḍa, He made them mad with love.[8]

47 In every village He passed through or stayed in, the people gained loving devotion, prema-bhakti.

48–49 If anyone heard Kṛṣṇa’s name from His mouth, another heard it from that person’s mouth, and yet another from his. Saying “Kṛṣṇa!” and “Hari!”, they all danced, wept and laughed, and so, one from another, people became Vaiṣṇavas in every land.

50 Although the Lord, wary of crowds, kept His love hidden and did not show it outwardly,[9]

51 still, by the power of seeing and hearing Him, the people of every land became Vaiṣṇavas.

52 He Himself travelled through Gauḍa, Vaṅga, Utkala and the South and delivered the people.

53 Ostensibly on His way to Mathurā, He came to Jhārikhaṇḍa, where the people were half-savage and the worst of unbelievers.[10]

54 Giving them the holy name and love, He delivered them all. Who has the power to understand the hidden pastimes of Caitanya?

55 Seeing a forest, He would take it for Vṛndāvana; seeing a hill, He would think it Govardhana.

56 Wherever He saw a river, He took it for the Kālindī. Overwhelmed by love, the Lord danced and fell down weeping.

57 As they went along the road, the Bhaṭṭācārya gathered whatever greens, roots and fruits he could find.

58 In whatever village the Lord stayed, five or seven brāhmaṇas would come and invite Him.

59 Some brought grain and left it with the Bhaṭṭācārya; some brought milk and yogurt, and some ghee and sugar.

60 Where there were no brāhmaṇas, respectable men of the śūdra community came and invited the Bhaṭṭācārya.[11]

61 The Bhaṭṭācārya cooked vegetables from the forest, and the Lord was delighted with them.

62–63 He kept with him grain for two or four days. Where the forest was empty and no one lived, the Bhaṭṭācārya cooked that grain and made dishes from fruits, roots and many kinds of forest greens.

64 The Lord was perfectly content with the forest fare, and He was happiest on the days He spent in solitude.

65 The Bhaṭṭācārya served Him lovingly, like a servant, and his brāhmaṇa carried the waterpot and the outer cloth.

66 He bathed three times a day in the warm water of springs, and at dawn and dusk He warmed Himself at a fire, for there was no end of firewood.[12]

67 Travelling in solitude, He was constantly absorbed in love. Feeling this happiness, the Lord said:

68 "Listen, Bhaṭṭācārya. I have travelled through many lands, but on this forest path I find not a trace of hardship anywhere.

69 Kṛṣṇa is merciful. He has shown Me great mercy: bringing Me by the forest path, He has given Me great happiness.

70 Earlier, when I set out for Vṛndāvana, I thought, 'I shall see My mother, the Gaṅgā and the devotees once more.

71 I shall surely meet the devotees, and I shall take them with Me to Vṛndāvana.'

72 With this in mind I went to Gauḍa, and My heart was happy to see My mother, the Gaṅgā and the devotees.

73 Then I joyfully set out with the devotees, and hundreds of thousands of people there joined Me.

74 Kṛṣṇa taught Me through Sanātana's mouth. He put an end to that journey and brought Me by the forest path.

75 He is an ocean of mercy, compassionate to the poor and the fallen. Without Kṛṣṇa's mercy there is no happiness at all."

76 Embracing the Bhaṭṭācārya, He said to him, "By your kindness I have found so much happiness."

77 He replied, "You are Kṛṣṇa! You are merciful! I am a fallen soul, yet You have been kind to me.

78 I am worthless, yet You have brought me with You. In Your mercy, my Lord, You have taken Your meals from my hand.

79 You have made a lowly crow equal to Garuḍa. You are the independent Lord, *Svayam Bhagavān* Himself."

80 "I bow down to Mādhava, the supreme bliss, whose mercy makes the mute eloquent and lets the lame cross a mountain." (Śrīdhara Svāmī, *Bhāvārtha-dīpikā* on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.1.1)[13]

81 In this way Balabhadra offered praise, and by his loving service he pleased the Lord.

82 So the Lord came joyfully to Kāśī, and there He took His midday bath at Maṇikarṇikā.[14]

83 At that time Tapana Miśra was bathing in the Gaṅgā, and he was surprised to see the Lord there.

84 "I heard earlier that the Lord had taken sannyāsa," he thought, and when he was sure it was He, his heart filled with joy.

85 Clasping the Lord's feet, he wept, and the Lord raised him up and embraced him.

86 He took the Lord to see Viśveśvara, and then they came and saw the feet of Bindu-mādhava.

87 Full of joy, he brought the Lord home, served Him, and danced, waving his cloth.

88 With all his family he drank the water that had washed the Lord's feet, and he honoured the Bhaṭṭācārya with worship.

89 He invited the Lord and fed Him in his home, having Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya do the cooking.

90 After His meal Mahāprabhu lay down to rest, and Miśra's son Raghu massaged His feet.[15]

91 Miśra and all his family ate the Lord's remnants. Hearing that the Lord had come, Candraśekhara came too.

92 He was Miśra's friend and an old servant of the Lord. A *vaidya* by caste and a scribe by profession, he lived in Vārāṇasī.

93 He came, fell at the Lord's feet and wept, and the Lord rose and mercifully embraced him.

94 Candraśekhara said, "Lord, You have shown me great mercy: You came Yourself to give Your servant Your darśana.

95 By my own *prārabdha*, the karma now bearing fruit, I live in Vārāṇasī, and my ears hear nothing but the words '*māyā*' and 'Brahman.'[16]

96 Here there is no talk but explanations of the six philosophies; but Miśra, in his kindness, lets me hear talks of Kṛṣṇa.[17]

97 We two constantly meditate on Your feet, and You, the omniscient Lord, have given us Your darśana.

98 I hear that Mahāprabhu is going to Śrī Vṛndāvana. Stay a few days and deliver Your two servants."[18]

99 Miśra said, "Lord, as long as You stay in Kāśī, please accept no invitation but mine."

100 So Mahāprabhu, yielding to His two servants, stayed there ten days, though He had no wish to.[19]

101 A brāhmaṇa from Mahārāṣṭra would come to see the Lord, and he marvelled at His beauty and His love.

102 All the brāhmaṇas invited Him, but the Lord would not accept. "Today I already have an invitation," He would say.[20]

103 In this way He evaded them every day. Wary of the company of the sannyāsīs, He accepted no invitations.[21]

104 Prakāśānanda Śrīpāda sat in his assembly and taught Vedānta to his many disciples.[22]

105 One brāhmaṇa who had seen the Lord's conduct came and told Prakāśānanda about Him.

106 "A sannyāsī has come from Jagannātha Purī. I cannot describe His glory and power.

107 Everything I see in Him is wonderful to tell: His body is tall and powerful, and His complexion is like pure gold.

108 His arms reach to His knees, His eyes are like lotuses, and He bears every auspicious mark of the Lord.

109 Seeing these marks, one understands, 'This is Nārāyaṇa.' Whoever sees Him begins to chant the names of Kṛṣṇa.

110 I hear in the *Bhāgavata* the marks of a *mahā-bhāgavata*, a great devotee, and I see all those marks plainly in Him.

111 His tongue sings Kṛṣṇa's name unceasingly, and tears flow from His eyes like the streams of the Gaṅgā.

112 At times He dances, laughs, sings and weeps; at times He roars like a lion.

113 His name, 'Kṛṣṇa Caitanya,' brings good to the whole world. His name, form and qualities are all beyond compare.

114 When you see Him, you know that His ways are the ways of the Lord. But who would believe such an extraordinary account just by hearing it?"

115 Hearing this, Prakāśānanda laughed heartily, and mocking the brāhmaṇa, he said:

116 "I have heard of Him — the sentimental sannyāsī from Gauḍa, a disciple of Keśava Bhāratī and a deceiver of people.[23]

117 His name is Caitanya. He goes about with His sentimentalists from land to land and village to village, making them dance.

118 Whoever sees Him declares Him to be God. Such is His art of enchantment: whoever looks at Him falls under its spell.

119 Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya is a formidable scholar, yet I hear that in Caitanya's company he has gone mad.

120 He is a sannyāsī in name only; in fact He is a great conjurer. But here in Kāśī His wares of emotion will not sell.[24]

121 Keep hearing Vedānta and do not go near Him. The company of unruly people ruins both this world and the next."[25]

122 Hearing this, the brāhmaṇa was deeply pained. Saying "Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!" he rose and left that place.

123 His mind had been purified by seeing the Lord. Sorrowfully he came before Him and told Him everything.

124 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu smiled slightly, and the brāhmaṇa asked the Lord again:

125 "When I spoke Your name before him, he himself said that he knew Your name.

126 While speaking of Your faults he uttered Your name, saying 'Caitanya, Caitanya' three times.

127 But not once in those three times did the name of Kṛṣṇa come to his lips. He takes Your name with contempt, and hearing it pains me.[26]

128 Please be kind and tell me the reason for this. When I see You, my mouth says 'Kṛṣṇa!' and 'Hari!' "

129 The Lord said, “The Māyāvādīs are offenders against Kṛṣṇa. They incessantly say ‘Brahman,’ ‘ātmā,’ ‘caitanya’ (consciousness).[27]

130 Therefore the name of Kṛṣṇa does not come to their lips. The name of Kṛṣṇa and Kṛṣṇa’s own form are one and the same.

131 The name, the form (*vigraha*) and the essential nature (*svarūpa*) are one. There is no difference among the three: all three are forms of consciousness and bliss.

132 In Kṛṣṇa there is no difference between the body and its possessor, or between the name and the one named. With the jīva it is otherwise: his name, his body and his true self differ from one another.

133 “The name is a wish-fulfilling gem; it is Kṛṣṇa Himself, the embodiment of consciousness and rasa — complete, pure and eternally liberated, for the name and the named are not different.” (Padma Purāṇa; Viṣṇu-dharmottara)[28]

134 Therefore Kṛṣṇa’s name, His body and His pastimes cannot be grasped by the material senses; they manifest themselves.

135 Kṛṣṇa’s name, His qualities and all His pastimes are equal to Kṛṣṇa’s own form: all of them are consciousness and bliss.

136 “Therefore Śrī Kṛṣṇa’s name, form, qualities and pastimes cannot be grasped by the material senses. When one is turned towards service, they reveal themselves of their own accord, beginning on the tongue.” (Padma Purāṇa; cited in Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.234)

137 The rasa of His pastimes is fuller bliss than the bliss of Brahman. It attracts even the knower of Brahman and makes him its own.

138 “His mind was filled with the happiness of the self, and so he had cast off every other feeling; yet his heart was drawn by the charming pastimes of the Unconquerable Lord, and in his mercy he brought forth the lamp of truth, the Purāṇa that tells of Him. To him, the son of Vyāsa, destroyer of all sins, I bow down.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 12.12.69)[29]

139 Kṛṣṇa’s qualities are fuller bliss than the bliss of Brahman. Therefore they attract the mind even of one who delights in the self.

140 “Even sages who delight in the ātmā and are free from the knots of the heart render causeless devotion to Urukrama, for such are the qualities of Hari.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.7.10)[30]

141 But leave all this aside: the very fragrance of tulasī that has touched Kṛṣṇa’s feet steals the mind of one who delights in the self.

142 “The breeze that bore the fragrance of tulasī, mingled with the pollen of the lotus-eyed Lord’s lotus feet, entered their nostrils and stirred both their minds and their bodies, though they were devoted to the imperishable Brahman.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.15.43)

143 Therefore the name of Kṛṣṇa does not come to the lips of the Māyāvādīs, for they are utterly averse to the Lord.

144 I came to Kāśī to sell My wares of emotion, but there is no buyer; they do not sell, so I shall have to take them back home.

145 I came with a heavy load — how can I carry it back? If I get even a small price, I will sell it right here.”[31]

146 Saying this, Gaurahari made that brāhmaṇa His own, and rising early the next morning He set out for Mathurā.

147 Those three followed Him, but the Lord forbade them, and from some way along the road He sent all three back home.

148 In separation from the Lord the three would meet together and sing of His qualities, maddened with love.

149 Coming to Prayāga, the Lord bathed in the river, and on seeing Mādhava He danced and sang in love.[32]

150 Seeing the Yamunā, He leapt into it in love, and the Bhaṭṭācārya hurriedly caught hold of Him and lifted Him out.

151 In this way He stayed three days in Prayāga, delivering the people by giving them the name of Kṛṣṇa and love for Him.

152 Wherever He stopped on the way to Mathurā, He gave the people the name of Kṛṣṇa and love for Him and made them dance.

153 As He had delivered the people before when He went to the south, so in the western lands He made everyone a Vaiṣṇava.

154 Wherever He caught sight of the Yamunā along the way, He leapt into it and fell unconscious in love.

155 When He drew near Mathurā and saw the city, He fell down flat like a rod, overwhelmed with love.

156 Arriving in Mathurā, He bathed at Viśrāma-tīrtha, and at the birthplace He saw Keśava and bowed down to Him.

157 Rapt in love, He danced, sang and roared again and again, and the people were astonished to see the Lord's rapture of love.

158 A brāhmaṇa fell down and clasped the Lord's feet, and then, overwhelmed with love, he danced with the Lord.

159 Dancing in love, the two embraced each other, and with arms raised they both called out, "Hari! Kṛṣṇa!"

160 The people cried, "Hari! Hari!" and a great tumult arose. Keśava's servant placed a garland on the Lord.

161 Seeing the Lord, the people were amazed and said, "Love such as this is never of this world.

162 At the sight of Him people become mad with love: they laugh, weep, dance and sing, chanting the name of Kṛṣṇa.

163 It is certain in every way that He is an avatāra of Kṛṣṇa. He has come to Mathurā to deliver the people."

164 Then Mahāprabhu took that brāhmaṇa aside, sat with him in private and asked him:

165 "You are noble and simple-hearted, an aged brāhmaṇa. Where did you get this treasure of love?"

166 The brāhmaṇa said, "Śrīpāda Mādhavendra Purī came to the city of Mathurā in the course of his wanderings.

167 Out of kindness he came to my home. He made me his disciple and accepted his meal (*bhikṣā*) from my hands.

168 That great soul brought Gopāla to light and served Him, and to this day Gopāla is served at Govardhana."

169 Hearing this, the Lord bowed down at the brāhmaṇa's feet, and the brāhmaṇa in fear fell at the Lord's feet.

170 The Lord said, "You are in the position of a guru, and I am like your disciple. It is not proper for a guru to bow down to a disciple."

171 Hearing this, the brāhmaṇa was astonished and said in fear, "You are a sannyāsī — why do You speak like this?

172 But seeing Your love, I infer that You have some connection with Mādhavendra Purī; I am sure of it.

173 Love for Kṛṣṇa is found where there is a connection with him. Without him there is not even a scent of such love anywhere."

174 Then the Bhaṭṭācārya told him of the connection, and hearing it the brāhmaṇa began to dance with joy.

175 Then the brāhmaṇa took the Lord to his own home and of his own accord rendered Him many kinds of service.

176 He had the Bhaṭṭācārya cook for the Lord's meal, but Mahāprabhu smiled and said:

177 "Purī Gosāñi has taken his meals in your house. You yourself give Me My meal — this is My instruction.

178 "Whatever the best of men does, others do the same; whatever standard he sets, the world follows." (Bhagavad-gītā, 3.21)[33]

179 That brāhmaṇa was a Sanoḍiyā, and sannyāsīs do not eat in a Sanoḍiyā's house.[34]

180 Nevertheless, seeing his Vaiṣṇava conduct, Purī made him his disciple and accepted meals from him.

181 When Mahāprabhu asked him for a meal, the brāhmaṇa humbly replied:

182 “To give You a meal is my great good fortune. You are the Lord; You are not bound by rules of conduct.

183 But foolish people will censure You, and I will not be able to bear the words of those wicked people.”[35]

184 The Lord said, “The śruti, the smṛti and all the sages are not of one opinion; they teach many different kinds of dharma.

185 The conduct of a sādhu is what establishes dharma, and the conduct of Purī Gosāñi is the essence of dharma.[36]

186 “Argument is inconclusive, the śrutis differ from one another, and there is no sage whose opinion does not differ from the others. The truth of dharma is hidden in the cave of the heart; the path is the one by which the great souls have gone.” (Mahābhārata, Vana-parva, 313.117)[37]

187 Then the brāhmaṇa served the Lord His meal, and all the people of Madhupurī (Mathurā) came to see the Lord.

188 People came by the hundreds of thousands, beyond counting, and the Lord came out of the house and showed Himself to them.

189 Raising His arms, the Lord called out, “Haribol!” and the people danced, mad with love, calling out the name of Hari.

190 The Lord bathed at the twenty-four ghāṭs of the Yamunā, and the brāhmaṇa showed Him the holy places.

191 He saw Svayambhu, Viśrāma, Dīrgha-viṣṇu, Bhūteśvara, Mahāvidyā, Gokarṇa and many other places.

192 When the Lord wished to see the forests, He took that same brāhmaṇa with Him.[38]

193 He went to Madhuvana, Tālavana, Kumudavana and Bahulāvana, bathing in each place and becoming overwhelmed with love.

194 On the way, a herd of grazing cows saw the Lord, came up lowing loudly and surrounded Him.

195 At the sight of the cows the Lord stood stunned in waves of love, and with motherly affection the cows licked His whole body.

196 Coming to Himself, the Lord stroked the cows, and they walked along with Him and would not leave Him.

197 With great difficulty the cowherd held all the cows back. Then herds of does, hearing the sound of the Lord's voice, came to Him.

198 Looking at His face, the bucks and does licked the Lord's body. Without any fear they followed Him along the paths.

199 Seeing the Lord, the parrots, cuckoos and bees sang in the fifth note (*pañcama*), and the peacocks went dancing before Him.

200 At the sight of the Lord, the trees and creepers of Vṛndāvana put forth sprouts like hair standing on end in ecstasy, and they rained honey like tears.

201 Their branches, laden with flowers and fruits, bent down to the Lord's feet, as a friend comes with a gift on seeing a friend.

202 All the moving and unmoving beings of Vṛndāvana rejoiced to see the Lord, as a friend rejoices on seeing his friends.

203 Witnessing their affection, the Lord, rapt in ecstasy, played with them all and gave Himself into their power.

204 The Lord embraced every tree and creeper, and in meditation He offered their flowers and other gifts to Kṛṣṇa.

205 His body was restless with the tears, trembling and thrills of love, and He called out in a loud voice, "Say 'Kṛṣṇa'! Say 'Kṛṣṇa'!"

206 All the moving and unmoving beings together cried out "Kṛṣṇa!", as if echoing the Lord's deep voice.

207 Embracing a deer around the neck, the Lord wept, and the deer's body thrilled, and tears filled its eyes.

208 On the branch of a tree a male and a female parrot appeared, and seeing them, the Lord wished to hear them say something.

209 The parrots flew down onto the Lord's hand, and began to recite verses on Kṛṣṇa's qualities for the Lord to hear.

210 (The male parrot recited:) "His beauty shatters the composure of the young women; His pastimes astonish Ramā (Lakṣmī); His strength turns the best of mountains into a ball; His spotless qualities are beyond all counting; His character delights all people. Ah, may our Lord Kṛṣṇa, the enchanter of the world, whose fame is a blessing for the whole world, protect the universe!" (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 13.29)

211 When she had heard the male parrot describe Kṛṣṇa, the female parrot recited a description of Rādhikā:

212 "Śrī Rādhikā's affection, the beauty of Her own form, Her good character, Her skill in dancing and singing, Her wealth of qualities and Her poetry shine forth; they enchant the heart of Him who enchants the minds of the whole world." (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 13.30)[39]

213 Again the male parrot said, "Kṛṣṇa is Madana-mohana, the enchanter of Cupid," and recited another verse:

214 "O Śārikā, He who holds the flute and steals the hearts of the women of the world, who sports with the cowherd maidens — may that Madana-mohana be victorious!" (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 13.31)

215 Then the female parrot spoke to the male parrot in jest, and hearing her, the Lord was filled with wonder and the joy of love:

216 "When He shines with Rādhā, then He is 'Madana-mohana,' the enchanter of Cupid. Otherwise, though He enchants the universe, He Himself is 'madana-mohita,' enchanted by Cupid." (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 13.32)[40]

217 The parrots flew back up to the branch of the tree, and the Lord eagerly watched the dancing of the peacocks.

218 Seeing the necks of the peacocks, the Lord remembered the lustre of Kṛṣṇa's body, and Mahāprabhu fell to the ground in the rapture of love.

219 Seeing the Lord unconscious, the brāhmaṇa and the Bhaṭṭācārya tried to revive Him.

220 Hurriedly they took Mahāprabhu's outer cloth, sprinkled His body with water and fanned Him with the cloth.

221 They spoke the name of Kṛṣṇa loudly in the Lord's ear, and regaining consciousness, the Lord rolled about on the ground.

222 In that forest, impassable with thorns, His body was scratched and cut. The Bhaṭṭācārya took the Lord on his lap and calmed Him.

223 In His absorption in Kṛṣṇa the Lord's mind was overwhelmed with love. Crying "Say it! Say it!" He got up and began to dance.

224 The Bhaṭṭācārya and the brāhmaṇa sang the name of Kṛṣṇa, and the Lord went on along the path, dancing all the way.

225 The brāhmaṇa was amazed to see the Lord's rapture of love, and he grew anxious about how to keep the Lord safe.

226 The absorption in love His mind had known in Nīlācala became a hundred times greater on the way to Vṛndāvana.

227 At the sight of Mathurā His love increased a thousandfold, and when He wandered in the forests it increased a hundred-thousandfold.

228–229 In other lands His love would overflow at the very name of Vṛndāvana, and now He was wandering in Vṛndāvana itself. His mind was overwhelmed with love night and day; He bathed, ate and did everything else only out of habit.

230 Such was His love all the while He wandered through the twelve forests. I have described it in one place; it cannot be described everywhere.

231 Ananta writes in millions of books about all the transformations of love the Lord showed in Vṛndāvana.

232 Yet even He cannot describe a particle of them. To give some indication, I only point the way.

233 The world was flooded by the ocean of Caitanya's pastimes; everyone swims in that ocean as far as his strength allows.

234 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. *Anubhāṣya*: the forest is the path through Jhārikhaṇḍa; seized by love for Kṛṣṇa, the beasts and birds danced with Gaura in self-forgetfulness. Edition heading: "Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, on His way to Vṛndāvana, gives love for Kṛṣṇa to beasts and birds." ↩
2. The same verse as Madhya 4.2 (the refrain of Ādi 4.2 with *gauracandra* in the first line); translation as there. ↩
3. *Snigdha*, "full of love": so Śrīdhara Svāmī explains *snigdhasya* in Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.1.8 — *premavataḥ*, "to one who is full of love" (*Anubhāṣya*). *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Lord does not want Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa and the others to go with Him as before, but He may take a new companion with a loving heart. ↩
4. Edition heading: "A simple brāhmaṇa, still strongly inclined to fruitive work, is given the chance to purify himself in the Lord's company." ↩
5. *Anubhāṣya*: the *mahā-bhāgavata* has realised non-dual knowledge; he sees nothing "second", apart from Kṛṣṇa, and so knows neither fear nor enmity. Everywhere he sees Kṛṣṇa and what belongs to Kṛṣṇa, and all beings in turn love him as their own. *Kṛtya* means bathing, chanting the mantra, remembrance and the like. ↩
6. *Anubhāṣya*: the gopīs sing this in autumn, when Kṛṣṇa wanders from forest to forest playing His flute; His attire is a garland of forest flowers, a crown of peacock feathers, earrings of guñjā berries; the black bucks (*kṛṣṇa-sāras*) are the does' mates. ↩
7. *Anubhāṣya*: so Brahmā saw Vṛndāvana when, after he had stolen the calves and cowherd boys, Kṛṣṇa mercifully lifted the veil of His māyā from him: it is the

abode of Ajita, and by its own glory anger, greed, thirst and the like had fled from it. ↩

8. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Jhārikhaṇḍa is a well-known forest region on the way to Vṛndāvana — today the hill and forest states of Athgarh, Dhenkanal, Angul, Lahara, Keonjhar, Bamra, Bonai, Gangpur, Chota Nagpur, Jashpur, Surguja and others. Edition heading: “In Jhārikhaṇḍa the Lord delivers all beings, moving and nonmoving — that is, He gives them devotion to Kṛṣṇa.” ↩
9. Edition heading: “Though before outsiders the Lord hides the signs of His love, people gain bhakti merely by seeing Him and hearing Him chant the name.” ↩
10. *Anubhāṣya*: *bhinna-prāya* — living apart from cultured society, that is, “almost savage”. Edition heading: “In Jhārikhaṇḍa the Lord delivers even people wholly turned away from Kṛṣṇa.” ↩
11. *Anubhāṣya*: where there were no brāhmaṇas by birth, the Bhaṭṭācārya was invited by “*śūdra-mahājanas*” — men born as śūdras who were brāhmaṇas by initiation (*daikṣya-brāhmaṇas*). By the rules of Śaṅkara’s sannyāsīs alms may be accepted only in the house of a brāhmaṇa by birth, but Mahāprabhu looked not at birth, only at whether a man was a Vaiṣṇava. Edition heading: “The Lord is served by brāhmaṇas by initiation.” ↩
12. Edition heading: “The Lord bathes in springs three times a day and keeps off the cold with a wood fire.” ↩
13. *Paramānanda-mādhava*, “Mādhava, the supreme bliss.” *Anubhāṣya*: the words name both Śrī Paramānanda Svāmī of the Viṣṇusvāmī line and Bhagavān Himself, the worshipful Lord of Śrīdhara Svāmī; the mute becomes eloquent in chanting of Kṛṣṇa, and the lame crosses the mountain, doing even the impossible in Kṛṣṇa’s service. Edition heading: the sixth verse of Śrīdhara Svāmī’s invocation at the start of his *Bhāvārtha-dīpikā* on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.1.1. ↩
14. *Anubhāṣya*: Kāśī, also called Vārāṇasī or Avimukta, is a most ancient city, named after the rivers Asi and Varuṇā. The name of the Maṇikarṇikā ghāṭa is explained in different ways: here a jewel (*maṇi*) fell from the ear (*karṇa*) of Viṣṇu — or, some say, of Śiva; or here Viśvanātha places in the ear of the dying the *tāraka-brahma*, the name of Rāma. ↩
15. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: this is Raghunātha, Tapana Miśra’s son, later renowned as Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī. ↩
16. *Anubhāṣya*: in Kāśī, chief holy place of the Śaivas and of the worshippers of five deities, there is no talk of serving Hari, and for a devotee of Gaura it is no place to live; so Candraśekhara bitterly says he lives there by his *prārabdha*, for past sins. This is self-reproach: a pure devotee may speak of himself so, but he

does not reap the fruits of good and bad deeds; even *sādhana-bhakti* destroys sin, its seed and ignorance. Edition heading: “Kāśī, where there is no talk of serving Hari, is the dwelling of the dry Māyāvādīs.” ↩

17. *Anubhāṣya*: the six *darśanas* are Vaiśeṣika (of the sage Kaṇāda), Nyāya (Gotama), Yoga (Patañjali), Sāṅkhya (Kapila), Pūrva- or Karma-mīmāṁsā (Jaimini) and Uttara- or Brahma-mīmāṁsā, that is, Vedānta (Vedavyāsa). ↩
18. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the two servants are Candraśekhara and Tapana Miśra. ↩
19. *Anubhāṣya*: Madhya 1.239 says that this time the Lord stayed four days in Tapana Miśra’s house in Kāśī. Edition heading: “Bhagavān is subject to His devotees.” ↩
20. Edition heading: “Māyāvādī brāhmaṇas, not Vaiṣṇavas, are unfit to give the Lord His meals.” ↩
21. Edition heading: “The Lord, playing the part of an ācārya, avoids the company of the Māyāvādīs.” ↩
22. *Anubhāṣya*: Prakāśānanda was an *ekadaṇḍī sannyāsī* of Śaṅkara’s line who lived in Kāśī in Mahāprabhu’s time; the Lord Himself speaks of him in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Madhya 3 and 20): explaining the Vedas, he rejects His form (*vigraha*) and calls His body, pastimes and abode false. He is in no way the same person as the *tridaṇḍī-svāmī* Śrī Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī, a follower of Rāmānuja from Śrī Raṅga-kṣetra, the guru and uncle of Śrīla Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī. ↩
23. *Anubhāṣya*: *bhāvuka*, “sentimentalist”: so the Māyāvādī Prakāśānanda calls the Lord, for he confuses Mahāprabhu’s transcendental *bhāva* with the artificial, short-lived fervour of those who follow a religion of the mind (*mano-dharma*); even the pure devotee’s spiritual chanting, dancing and music he puts on a level with worldly song and dance. Edition heading: “Prakāśānanda spews the poison of his Māyāvāda.” ↩
24. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *bhāvakāli* — the ways of a *bhāvuka*, a sentimentalist. The Lord takes up this image in verses 144–145. ↩
25. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the unruly are those who have broken the bonds of scriptural injunctions. ↩
26. *Anubhāṣya*: *doṣa* — blasphemy. Names such as ‘Brahman’, ‘Caitanya’, ‘Ātmā’, ‘Paramātmā’ and ‘Īśvara’, as the Māyāvādī understands them, point only in part to Kṛṣṇa’s majesty, never to His generosity and sweetness. The Māyāvādīs do not believe that the name, form, qualities and pastimes of the Absolute are spiritual, and so they are great offenders; one who seeks the highest good should not hear talk of the highest goal from their lips. ↩

27. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Māyāvādī calls the form of Bhagavān “a form made of *māyā*” and holds His name, form, qualities and pastimes to be non-eternal. Rejecting Kṛṣṇa’s principal names (*mukhya-nāma*), he utters secondary ones (*gauṇa-nāma*) — ‘Brahman’, ‘Ātmā’, ‘Caitanya’. Even if “Kṛṣṇa” or “Govinda” escapes his lips, the name of Kṛṣṇa still does not come from his mouth, for he takes it to be an ordinary, mundane word. ↩
28. The source as in the edition’s heading: “a saying of the *Padma Purāṇa* and the *Viṣṇu-dharmottara*”. *Anubhāṣya*: *kṛṣṇaḥ* — the name is Kṛṣṇa Himself in His original form; *pūrṇaḥ* — māyā cannot divide it; *śuddhaḥ* — it is unmixed with māyā. ↩
29. *Anubhāṣya*: having finished telling the *Bhāgavatam* to the sages headed by Śaunaka, Śrī Sūta Gosvāmī bows down to his guru, Śrīla Śuka Gosvāmī, Brahmarāta; *sva-sukha-nibhṛta-cetāḥ* — one whose heart is full of the happiness of the self, an *ātmārāma*. ↩
30. The same verse as Madhya 6.186; translation as there. ↩
31. *Anubhāṣya*: the small price is eager longing (*laulya*), greed (*lobha*), or taste (*ruci*) for the service of Kṛṣṇa; it cannot be had without self-surrender (compare the verse of the *Padyāvalī* cited in Madhya 8.70). *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Lord sells this heavy load to the jīvas for its full price, faith (*śraddhā*), but here He will give it even for a small one — a mere semblance of faith (*śraddhābhāsa*). ↩
32. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Mādhava is Veṇī-Mādhava, the Deity of Prayāga (the edition’s heading names Bindu-Mādhava). *Anubhāṣya*: Prayāga is the king of tīrthas, the confluence of the Gaṅgā and the Yamunā (Triveṇī). ↩
33. The same verse as Ādi 3.25; translation as there. ↩
34. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in the western country the vaiśyas are divided into several groups — Agarwals, Kalwars, Sanwars and others; the Kalwars, Sanwars and some others have fallen through faults in their occupations. Brāhmaṇas who serve as their priests are called Sanoḍiyā brāhmaṇas; they have fallen by such service, and so sannyāsīs do not eat in their homes. Edition heading: “by birth-lineage (*śaukra*) that brāhmaṇa’s food is not accepted.” ↩
35. *Anubhāṣya*: by birth this pure devotee did not belong to those from whose hands water may be taken, yet he was fixed in the truth and in *daiva-varṇāśrama*, favourable to bhakti. So he fearlessly calls “fools” and “wicked” those who oppose Mahāprabhu and pure bhakti and see caste in a Vaiṣṇava. ↩
36. *Anubhāṣya*: the sādhu is the *mahājana*. A mind that relies on the senses cannot recognise the true *mahājana*; in the age of Kali the *mahājanas* are the four

ācāryas of the sampradāyas of pure Vaiṣṇavas, and in our sampradāya — Śrī Svarūpa Dāmodara, Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana and the followers of Śrī Rūpa. ↩

37. *Anubhāṣya*: *guhā* — the cave of the heart of the sampradāya of pure sādhus, hidden from the eyes of ordinary people; *mahājana* — the sādhu, the servant of Adhokṣaja. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the truth of dharma is hard to grasp merely by reading the scriptures, so all should follow the path that one whom the sādhus have accepted as a *mahājana* has called "the path of the scriptures". ↩
38. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the forests are the twelve forests of Vraja: east of the Yamunā — Bhadravana, Bilvavana, Lohavana, Bhāṇḍīravana and Mahāvana; west of it — Madhuvana, Tālavana, Kumudavana, Bahulāvana, Kāmavana, Khadiravana and Vṛndāvana. ↩
39. The edition reads *svarūpatā* (in the verse and in the gloss of the *Anubhāṣya*); another reading is *su-rūpatā*, "beauty". *Anubhāṣya*: *svarūpatā* — extraordinary beauty, or the form of *mahābhāva* in which Her own self is revealed. ↩
40. *Anubhāṣya*: when Kṛṣṇa is not with Rādhā, He Himself is enchanted by Madana (Kandarpa), as in the *Gīta-govinda* (3.2): "Having searched for Rādhikā everywhere, His heart tormented by the wounds of Anaṅga's arrows…" ↩